singled out for legal discrimination as well as made scapegoats during crises; such ethnic riots as Japan has seen were perpetuated against resident Koreans, most notably after the 1923 Great Kantō Earthquake, when they were accused of poisoning water supplies.[4]

Given the miniscule number of foreigners in Japan in the nineteenth century, the modern Japanese state was not unified in the 1870s by the repression of foreign nationalities or ethnicities; nevertheless, the sense of "Japanese-ness" that accompanied modernization was driven by the exclusion of others from an already homogeneous society. Unlike in modern Europe—where ethnic groups compete not only for geographic but also political space—in Japan, a powerful sense of universal group identity serves to unify politics and society, particularly after World War II. Resistance to the state has been mainly driven by the importation of Western socialist ideology, expressed largely through workers' unions and leftist parties during the first half of the 1900s, along with a brief spasm of student-led rebellion in the 1960s, but little after that. Instead, most Japanese appear to welcome the physical security brought about by Japan's exclusionary nationalism, even as they choose how and when to integrate with the surrounding world.

Modernization in a Mirror

The triumphal post–Cold War West has lost, if it ever had, the understanding that societal openness and globalization are only a means and not an end. Victory over two existential geopolitical foes in one century may have engendered a hubristic sense that no enemy foreign or domestic could really threaten the West's survival. Ironically, this sense of security allowed for the internal spread of a cultural and moral relativism that proposed a radically altered conception of the nation and threatened to undermine the very tenets of traditional Western civilization. This relativism surreptitiously took over the commanding heights of society, starting in the 1960s, spreading from